

Another World

Ice Breaker · Saturday, Oct 10 · about 5 minutes

1	0:00	Hello	center
2	0:50	My first world	your right
3	1:30	My second world	your left
4	2:45	The strange part	center
5	3:25	A new feeling	center
6	4:05	Why I am here	center

● 4:00 ● 5:00 ● 6:00 Yellow before part 6? Jump to the closing.

(Blue) = what to do.

Bold = say it slowly.

Orange bar = learn by heart.

1 • Hello

0:00 • Center

BY HEART

Привет. (pause) Salom. (pause)

안녕하세요. (pause) Hello.

Toastmaster of the day, fellow
Toastmasters, and dear guests.

You just heard “hello” in four languages: Russian, Uzbek, Korean, and English. My name is Azizjon. (pause) Azizjon Kasimov. I am from Uzbekistan, and I am an AI engineer here in Daejeon.

Here is something strange.
Russian is my first language. I
grew up with it. **But now, speaking
Russian is hard for me.** How did
that happen? Let me tell you about
my two worlds.

2 · My first world

0:50 · *Step to your right (the past)*

I grew up in Tashkent, the capital of Uzbekistan, in a Russian-speaking family. At home, everything was in Russian. My family, my childhood, my first memories. All in Russian.

And Uzbek, the language of my country? Yes, I said “Salom” at the start. But I can barely speak Uzbek. *(pause, small shrug)*

So my first world was in Russian. For me, it was just normal. I never thought about it. When you live inside a language, you don't see it. A fish does not see the water.

3 · My second world

1:30 · *Walk to your left (the present)*

Then I came to Korea to study at Woosong University, here in Daejeon. And a new world started.

I started learning Korean for daily life. 아직 공부 중이에요. *(pause, smile)* I am still learning. But my main language here became English. At first, it was just a tool for work. I became an AI engineer. I build models that forecast solar power, find hidden problems in data, and predict prices.

At work, I speak one more language. A programming language: Python. *(pause)* Python is the perfect listener. It never interrupts me. It never gets bored. But when I make one small mistake, it tells me right away.

(robot voice) “Error.” *(pause)*

Slowly, English moved from my work into my whole life. Today I speak English almost all day. With friends, with new people, and at home with my girlfriend. **English is not my work language anymore. It is my life language.**

4 • The strange part

2:45 • Come back to the center (now)

And here is the strange part.

(point back to the past side) When I look back at the years when I spoke mostly Russian, they feel like another world. And now, when I speak Russian, I have to stop and search for words. **My first language became my second language.** *(pause)*

This taught me something. A language is not just words. It is a whole world. **When your language changes, your world changes too.**

5 · A new feeling

3:25 · Center

But recently, I noticed one more change. This one is not a new language. It is a new feeling.

Talking to people became easier. More than that, it became fun. I can share my ideas, and people understand me.

This year, I tried new things. I started a small tech meetup here, called Daejeon Global Tech Coffee. And last month, I started teaching English as a volunteer. It was my first time ever teaching English. Step by step, it got easier.

6 · Why I am here

4:05 · Center

I want more of that feeling. That is why I am here. I came to this club three times as a guest. Then my girlfriend and I joined the club together.

My goal is simple: take every role I can, and speak as much as I can. And I like that here, people tell you what you did wrong. Just like Python. *(pause)* But much more kindly.

BY HEART

Every language gave me a new world. Now I want to get better at sharing my world with other people. Today, I shared a little of it with you.

I started with “hello” in four languages. Let me finish with “thank you” in four languages.

Спасибо. Rahmat. 감사합니다.
Thank you.